

4-13-2021 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=peV5iTsqP7k
Publication Date	2021-04-14T09:54:30Z
Target Category	mcs

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees Meeting Report

Meeting Date: April 13, 2021

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees was called to order on Tuesday, April 13, 2021, by the presiding officer, followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mrs. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Low, and Pastor Keith (referred to in discussion).
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heater.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title, but led by the board president/chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opened with a moment of silence and recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** (Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text prior to substantive business).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:22 MCS BSU Social Studies Curriculum Project Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by Rhonda (Director of Diversity), Dr. Sharon Fraser Burgess (Professor of Social Foundations & Multicultural Education at Ball State University), Julie Snyder (Social Studies Department Chair at Muncie Central High School), A.J. Bradley (Middle School Teacher at Southside Middle School), and Alton Jackson (Community Member and Parent).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presenters provided an update on the three-year participatory action research project focused on diversifying the social studies curriculum, de-centering whiteness, and fostering democratic civic engagement through culturally relevant teaching. The first year serves as a baseline/collaboration phase. The upcoming summer will involve intensive curriculum development backed by a \$20,000 Library of Congress "Teaching with Primary Sources" grant and consulting from the National Council of History Education. Board members expressed strong support, discussing the importance of current events, critical thinking, teacher agency, and expanding these principles across other subject areas.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Alton Jackson (00:14:39) spoke from a parent's perspective, sharing how witnessing events in Minneapolis in 2020 inspired him to help broaden local history education. He emphasized that teaching complete, multi-perspective history equips students with a "private school education in a public setting" and provides them with a competitive edge in a global society.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote required or conducted.
- **00:44:23 Consent Agenda (Items A through F)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Board Leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed consent agenda items A through f, noting extensive donations to the Panther pantry and recognizing retiring staff member Jackie Cole (Longfellow Elementary, 34 years of service).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:45:41 Annual Lease Agreement for Northside Middle School**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer / Administrator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the new three-year annual lease agreement with Ball State University for Northside Middle School.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:46:31 Financial Report (March 2021)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the monthly financial results for March, noting that the education fund remains projected to finish the school year in

a surplus and healthy cash balances are expected through December 2021. He also reported on recent coordination with DLGF field auditors regarding preliminary 2022 and 2023 budgets, tax caps, and upcoming general obligation bond balloon payments.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general open public comment period or citizen speakers from the floor occurred during this portion of the meeting (public input was integrated into the specific social studies curriculum presentation).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Dr. Kyokowski (Superintendent / Administrator updates):**
 - Southside Middle School experienced temporary electrical issues requiring an e-learning day, but power was successfully restored.
 - Teacher Kelsey Paul Valka from West View was named an Armstrong Teacher Educator Award recipient by the IU School of Education.
 - Summer program overviews and applications are now live on the district website, with commitments to expand capacity if spots fill up.
 - Volunteer programs are reopening, requiring proof of vaccination for volunteers.
 - Kindergarten and pre-K registration efforts are underway, including creative community incentives.
 - Ball State University's Day of Service is scheduled for the upcoming Saturday to assist with school beautification projects.
 - A promotional brochure for the West View dual language program (created in partnership with BSU) was distributed to board members.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion and voice vote, with members noting a baseball game departure. Disposition: **Approved by Voice Vote** (meeting adjourned).